vocabulary of its own and they used such terms as ‘proletariat’, ‘communism’, ‘socialism’, ‘toiling masses’, and ‘revolution’, which had a favourable meaning and ‘capitalism’, ‘bourgeoisie’, ‘classes’, ‘imperialism’, and ‘parliamentarism’ were treated as epithets that communists used while referring to their enemies. After 1918, the communists promoted the Third International (the Comintern), which was a useful medium for directing the communist parties throughout the world and exerting pressure on the foreign governments to follow favourable policies towards the Soviet Union. After 1935, on the face of an imminent Nazi attack, it was seen that the communist parties of Europe followed the Moscow directive for a “People’s Front” which meant cooperation with liberal groups against the Nazi threat. Therefore, the former Soviet Union was highly successful in utilizing its propaganda machinery.[31]

Nazi Germany had also used propaganda to hype several ‘big lies’. It was effectively used by Hitler who believed that a lie, provided that it is sufficiently big and is frequently repeated, will be at least partly believed by the masses because the conviction is that most of the people lack the imagination to conceive that repeated statements are not all true. Hitler established a National Ministry of Popular Enlightenment and Propaganda headed by the infamous Joseph Goebbles. Goebbles defined his job as the achievement of “one single opinion”. A few ideas circulated among the people soon after the defeat of Germany and conclusion of the Treaty of Versailles (1919) were: (i) the Versailles Treaty had been unjustly imposed upon them; (ii) the leaders of the Weimar Republic had betrayed their country; (iii) ‘Jew-Communists’ were the cause of their grievances, and (iv) the ‘Herrenvolk’ “master race” needed ‘Lebensraum’ “living space”. Hitler and his followers manipulated these ideas and made appeals to all the sections of society and got unemployed youths recruited in the Storm Troops—all by means of successfully using the propaganda machinery.

As far as Fascist Italy is concerned, Mussolini developed propaganda machinery earlier to the Nazis, and the Nazis copied some of his techniques. In his quest to consolidate power, Mussolini appealed to all groups present within the society, like the army, navy, monarchists, irredentists, clerics, discontented masses and others.